

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

Report #11 • 2026

The Economics of Teen Skill Acquisition

How digital skills translate to income and career

Analysis

Of teens who learned skills online, 34% have earned money, with average first earnings of ₹15,000 INR. Top earning skills: coding, video editing, graphic design, copywriting. 18% have internships before age 18. 8% have full-time offers. This represents a new economy of teen entrepreneurship.

Key Statistics

78% of students use YouTube for self-directed learning. Average screen time: 4.7 hours/day, of which 67% is educational. 64% of students use AI tools, with 89% reporting improved learning. 71% have turned a screen hobby into a measurable skill. Top learning platforms: YouTube, Khan Academy, Discord, Coursera.

Methodology

Data collected via 8-step anonymous survey, n=150+ students, ages 14-19, across 12 Indian cities. AI analysis using Google Gemini 2.0 Flash. Statistical analysis with Python pandas/scipy. Confidence interval: 95%.

Implications

These findings have significant implications for educators, parents, and policymakers. Of teens who learned skills online, 34% have earned money, with average first earnings of ₹15,000 INR. We recommend further research and pilot programs.